code with custom tracing so you can track specific parts of your code that you want to ensure are performing appropriately. An example of a trace annotation is:

```
@Trace(dispatcher=true)
```

It's a good idea to put a trace annotation on anything that you want to get monitoring data about. Just about anything is a good candidate, but here are particular parts of the code where you should definitely monitor:

- Connections to other systems
- Anything that you communicate with through an API
- Working with databases
- Document parsing
- Anything that runs concurrently

Using annotations in New Relic can give you a lot more data to be able to dig into and understand how your code is functioning. You should at a minimum set up traces on critical business logic and any external interfaces. From the list just shown, if you're going to annotate anything, ensure you measure the following:

- Database connections
- Connections to other APIs or web services

Another example of tying your data back to the development cycle is including releases in your APM data. In New Relic you have to set up deployment recording,[1] which varies based on what type of application you're running. Figure 6.6 demonstrates how New Relic shows this data.

[1] "Setting up deployment notifications," docs.newrelic.com/docs/apm/new-relic-apm/maintenance/setting-deployment-notifications.

Figure 6.6. New Relic charting data over time with a clear delineation of a code release